

VPNs are easy to build

DO YOU KNOW HOW EASY IT IS TO BUILD A VPN THESE DAYS?

No? Well, let me help you out then. Start off by opening a new account on any of the numerous cloud services out there which can give you a dedicated server for yourself. If the ingress and egress data caps are liberal, then that's the best service for making a VPN. If you're on AWS, then once you've created an account, you will have to head over to Services and then the IAM (Identity and Access Management) under the Security tab. Head to the Users tab and add a new user. Set it to Programmatic Access and then attach existing policies directly. Type in "admin" in the box that appears and that should list a couple of policies. You'll need to select the one that says "Administrator Access". Finish the setup process by clicking through to the next screen till you find an option that allows you to download the access keys in a CSV file.

Now, on your Windows device, open the Settings window and head to 'Update & Security'. In the left-hand panel look for 'For Developers'. In the right-hand panel, toggle the 'Developers Mode' switch. Next head to 'Turn Windows features on or off' and then install 'Windows Subsystem for Linux'. Reboot your PC once you're done with all this.

After the PC has booted and you're back into Windows, fire up a Command Line window. Type the following and press Enter: *"sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get install python-pip python-setuptools build-essential libssl-dev libffi-dev python-dev python-virtualenv git -y"*

Follow that up with

"git clone https://github.com/trailofbits/alg0 && cd alg0"

Now, head to the newly cloned folder, wherever it is located on your PC, and you'll find all the necessary files. Don't close the command line prompt yet. Type *"sudo nano config.cfg"* and press Enter. Add however many users that you want. Save the file with Ctrl+X. You should be back in the command prompt window now. Type *"/alg0"* and press Enter. Answer the prompts that appear as per the Cloud service that you've opted for. Amazon EC2 will be option 2. Type in the

name for your VPN and then choose the server location. You'll soon be prompted for the access keys that you had downloaded from Amazon in the form of the CSM file. Input the access key and secret key when asked for. The next couple of options can be answered with the "Yes" option for easy configurability and added security features.

That's it, you're done. It took me 420 words (no reference to anything shady here, I'm not Elon Musk) to describe an easy method to create a VPN. And if you've managed to follow this simple tutorial, you'll have created your own VPN. You can now configure your Windows PC, Android or iOS smartphone, etc. to use the newly created VPN for all your surfing. And if you're bored or a little paranoid, then you can easily kill the current instance and set up a new instance on a completely different cloud service provider and input the new access and secret keys to reconnect to your new VPN. The entire process should take you no more than 15-20 minutes. Even lesser, once you've practised the whole process.

Please note, that you will have to obey the law of the land and store data pertaining to your activities for a period of five years and turn them over to the authorities whenever it is demanded. So keep that in mind while you're going about creating your VPN. Wait a minute, it would seem that the new laws around VPNs are applicable to VPN companies and not to private individuals so you might not be required to keep any logs at all. Your cloud service provider might be forced to keep logs but the traffic coming in is obfuscated anyway so that doesn't matter. And if the outlet can be monitored, then you simply need to get another cloud service which does not exist in India and tunnel the outlet to the new server. That should take care of the outlet as well. 



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